

Magnetic Field Scanner (MFS) Wand

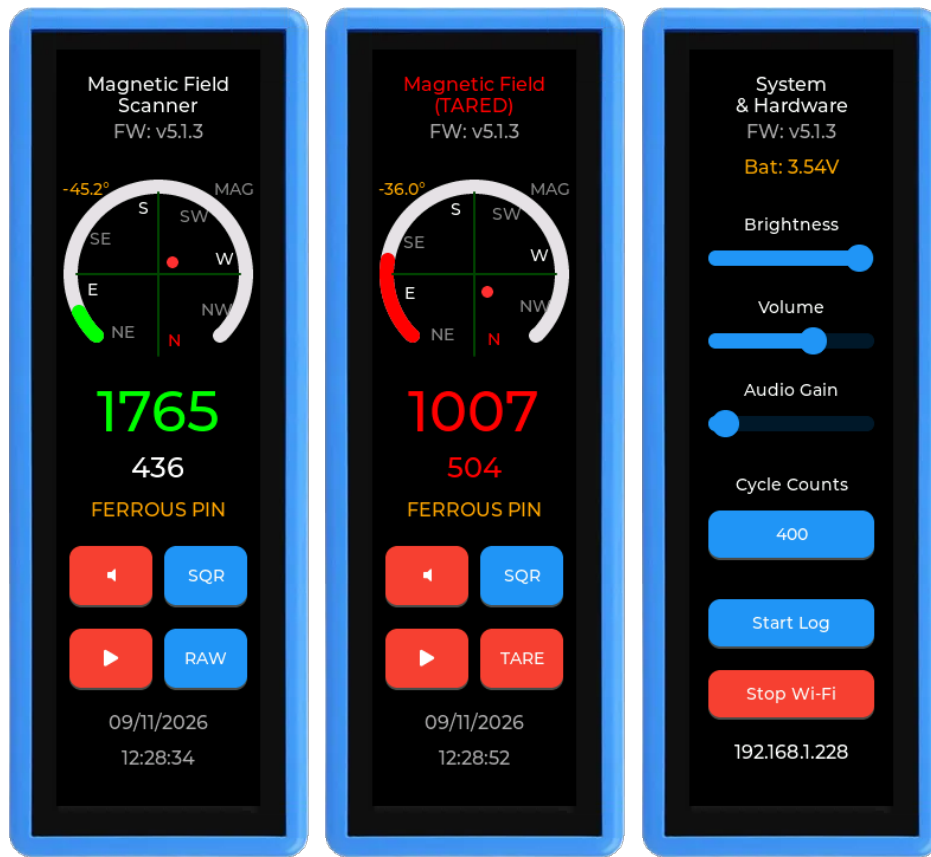
License [GPLv3](#) Firmware [v5.1.4](#) Platform [ESP32-S3](#)

A professional-grade, open-source spatial magnetic gradiometer designed to detect buried ferromagnetic anomalies (property pins, pipes, UXO) by isolating highly localized magnetic gradients from the Earth's background magnetic field.

Powered by an ESP32-S3 and utilizing dual PNI RM3100 magneto-inductive sensors, this device achieves nanotesla-level sensitivity, executing 9-parameter ellipsoidal matrix calibrations and real-time Madgwick AHRS sensor fusion to provide an intuitive, HUD-style radar interface on a high-speed LCD.







Hardware Configuration

Core Components

- **Base Platform:** Waveshare ESP32-S3-Touch-LCD-3.49 v3 (PCBA v1.1 silkscreen). This highly integrated device provides the MCU, display, audio, and power management core.
- **MCU:** ESP32-S3 (16MB Flash, OPI PSRAM) embedded on the Waveshare board.
- **Magnetometers:** 2x RM3100 (TIP (at 0") and REF (at 24") sensors), with hardware reserved for a 3rd (NEAR at 8").
- **IMU:** QMI8658 (6-axis Accelerometer & Gyroscope) offset mechanically by 60° relative to the wand axis.
- **Display:** 172x640 QSPI LCD with capacitive touch.
- **Audio Codec:** ES8311 / ES7210 via I2S for audio feedback.
- **Storage:** External SPI SD Card + Internal FFat (Flash).
- **Wiring:** See the [MFS Wiring Diagram](#).
- **RTC:** PCF85063 for precise timestamping.
- **I/O Expander:** TCA9554 to offload static control pins (Backlight, Resets) and free up high-speed GPIO.

Pin Allocations & Rationale

To support this many peripherals on a single ESP32-S3, strict pin management and an I2C I/O expander are utilized.

Feature	GPIO / Pin	Protocol / Type	Rationale
I2C Bus	SDA: 47, SCL: 48	I2C	Shared bus for RM3100s, IMU, RTC, and TCA9554 IO Expander (capped at 200kHz for cable capacitance).
I2S Audio	MCLK: 7, BCLK: 15, WS: 46, DIN: 6, DOUT: 45	I2S	Full duplex audio codec interface.
SD Card	CS: 38, MOSI: 39, MISO: 40, SCLK: 41	SPI	Dedicated high-speed SPI bus for high-bandwidth data logging.
LCD Display	CS: 9, PCLK: 10, D0-D3: 11, 12, 13, 14, TE: 21	QSPI / 8080	High-speed bus dedicated to driving the 172x640 LVGL display.
Battery ADC	4	Analog (ADC1)	Dedicated for battery voltage monitoring.
RM3100 DRDY	TIP: 3, REF: 2, NEAR: 5	Interrupt	Direct hardware interrupts for DRDY synchronization.

Feature	GPIO / Pin	Protocol / Type	Rationale
Future GPS	TX: 43, RX: 44	UART	Reserved. Freed up by migrating static control pins to the IO Expander.

TCA9554 I/O Expander (Address 0x20)

Used to handle low-speed/static signals to conserve MCU pins:

- **P0:** Touch Interrupt
- **P1:** LCD Backlight Enable
- **P2 / P3:** IMU Interrupts 1 & 2
- **P4:** RTC Interrupt
- **P5:** LCD Reset
- **P6:** System Power Enable (Keep-alive)
- **P7:** Night/Sleep Mode

Software Architecture (v5.x.x)

The software is built on the Arduino ESP32 Core but heavily utilizes ESP-IDF native features and FreeRTOS for professional-grade isolation and performance.

1. Synchronized POLL Architecture & FreeRTOS

The v5.x.x architecture completely eliminates I2C collisions and phase-drift by orchestrating synchronized measurements:

- **POLL Mode:** The ESP32 broadcasts a simultaneous `REG_POLL` command to both RM3100 sensors across the I2C bus.
- **Event Groups (Core 0):** The Sensor Task sleeps at 0% CPU until both hardware `DRDY` GPIO interrupts assert, guaranteeing absolute temporal synchronization between the Tip and Reference sensors before reading.
- **LVGL UI Task (Core 1):** Handles display rendering, capacitive touch input, and real-time radar / minimap animations without interrupting the rigid I2C sensor polling pipeline.

2. Deep Mathematics: Kabsch & Madgwick Algorithms

To achieve military-grade spatial accuracy, the ESP32 natively executes advanced matrix mathematics and 9-axis sensor fusion:

- **Kabsch Rotational Alignment:** The system applies a 9-parameter Least-Squares Ellipsoid Fit (using a Jacobi Eigenvalue solver and the Kabsch Algorithm) to correct for Hard and Soft Iron magnetic distortions caused by the battery and LCD.
- **Madgwick 9-Axis Sensor Fusion:** The raw 3-axis Tip magnetometer data is fused with the QMI8658's 6-axis IMU (Accelerometer and Gyroscope) via an asynchronous Madgwick AHRS filter. This provides real-time Pitch, Roll, and Yaw (Azimuth) compensation to project the magnetic vector accurately to the Earth's gravity vector.
- **Universal Domain Shifting:** The `v5.1.x` architecture converts raw sensor LSBs into normalized physical nanoTeslas (nT) *before* applying the Kabsch calibration matrix. Because the matrix becomes mathematically dimensionless, a single calibration profile works universally across ALL Cycle Counts (12 to 3200).

3. Dynamic UI Scaling (RAW, TARE, and AUTO)

The LVGL Gradiometer UI dynamically scales its physical range and color bands based on the active mode:

- **RAW Mode (0 - 25,000 nT):** Wide dynamic range to absorb the baseline physical misalignment of the sensors (typically ~4,900 nT) without pinning the needle in the red.
- **TARE Mode (0 - 5,000 nT):** Manual zeroing of the baseline, tightening the visual arc (Green: 0-150, Yellow: 150-500, Red: >500) for extreme sensitivity to tiny localized anomalies.
- **AUTO Mode (0 - 5,000 nT):** Engages an invisible low-pass filter (triggered under 150 nT) that acts as an aggressive Auto-Tare to slowly eat away temperature drift and background anomalies while ignoring the sharp gradients of a real target.

4. Dual-Drive Filesystem & Integrated Web Server

- **Smart Fallback:** Dynamically routes file I/O to the high-speed SD Card, or falls back to Internal FFat if the card is missing or corrupted.
- **Captive Portal:** Hosts a Web Server allowing seamless download of `.csv` characterization logs and upload of `calibration.json` profiles.

Real-World Capabilities & Detection Depth

The Magnetic Field Scanner is designed as a spatial gradiometer. Because it relies on an empirical RMS noise floor of $\pm 0.33 \mu\text{T}$ (at 400 CC), it is highly sensitive to buried ferromagnetic objects.

Use Case: Locating Property Pins (5/8" Rebar)

A standard 5/8" steel property pin driven vertically into the earth acts as a magnetic monopole, concentrating the Earth's magnetic flux at its tip.

Estimated Detection Depth:

- A vertical 5/8" property pin generates a surface anomaly of roughly $500 \mu\text{T}$ at 1 inch.
- Because the wand is a gradiometer with a long handle, the near-field gradient of a monopole decays according to the inverse-cube law ($1/r^3$).
- To be reliably detected above the wand's noise floor, the signal needs a minimum Signal-to-Noise Ratio (SNR).
- In a magnetically quiet environment (RAW mode), you can expect to reliably detect a standard vertical property pin buried under **1.5 to 2 feet (18 to 24 inches)** of dirt or concrete.

Practical Tips for Pin Locating

- **Sweep Low:** Keep the tip sensor as close to the ground as possible. Every inch of air gap costs you an inch of dirt penetration.
- **Use Audio:** Rely on the dynamic FOC audio feedback. The human ear is incredibly adept at picking up the slow frequency rise of a deep anomaly long before the UI screen indicates a massive spike.
- **Vertical vs Horizontal:** Property pins driven vertically are *much* easier to detect than pipes lying horizontally, because the vertical rod concentrates the Earth's magnetic field directly into a concentrated point (a monopole) at the surface.

System Characterization

The wand features a rigid characterization methodology to empirically validate its hardware envelope across multiple Cycle Counts (CC=200, 400, 3200). To test your hardware, use the included Python script on your generated .csv logs:

```
python scripts/characterize_system.py --noise "log_noise_200.csv" "log_noise_400.csv" "log_noise_3200.csv"
```

See docs/characterization_methodology.md for full instructions.

Future Expansion Roadmap

The hardware architecture has been deliberately designed to accommodate future capabilities without requiring a PCB spin:

1. 3D Depth Sensing (3rd RM3100)

A dedicated interrupt pin (GPIO 5) and I2C address (0x22) have been reserved for a 3rd RM3100 sensor (NEAR).

- **Purpose:** Enables 2nd-order magnetic gradiometry, allowing the wand to calculate the exact depth of a magnetic anomaly (e.g., a buried pipe) rather than just its presence.

2. Spatial Mapping (GPS / RTK)

The static control pins for the LCD and IMU were aggressively offloaded to the TCA9554 I/O expander specifically to free up the hardware UART pins:

- **TX (GPIO 43) / RX (GPIO 44):** Reserved for a high-precision GPS or RTK module. This will allow the wand to fuse magnetic gradient data with precise geographic coordinates, generating professional magnetic survey heatmaps.

How to Build & Deploy

Prerequisites

- **Environment:** Arduino IDE v2+ or VSCode/Arduino.
- **Core:** ESP32 Board Package v3.3.x (ESP-IDF v5 based).

Board Settings (ESP32-S3 Dev Module)

- **USB Mode:** Hardware CDC and JTAG
- **PSRAM:** OPI PSRAM
- **Flash Mode:** QIO 80MHz
- **Flash Size:** 16MB (128Mb)
- **Partition Scheme:** Custom or `app3M_fat9M_16MB`
- **Core Debug Level:** None (for performance)

Compilation Note

All code files adhere to a strict Semantic Versioning (vx.y.z) rule enforced at every file iteration. Ensure you are building the latest `user_config.h` baseline.

Open Source & Contributing

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